

SIMPLE FINESSE

South opens with a 5+-card major and the partnership reaches a major game or 3NT. South declares.

Teaching feature: South holds an AQ in a SIDE suit without the K. The K is in East or West, roughly half the time each way.

- When South opens 1♠, the finesse suit is ♥ (AQ-no-K).
- When South opens 1♥, the finesse suit is ♠ (AQ-no-K).
- 5-3-3-2 hands sometimes open 1NT and play 3NT — finesse still applies.

To take the finesse: lead small from dummy toward South's hand and play the Q if East follows small. The Q wins about half the time.

Things to think about:

- Count winners and losers first.
- When in the play should you take the finesse?
- If the finesse loses, where else can you make tricks?
- Did the auction or the opening lead hint where the K sits?

Reference:

<https://www.bridgebum.com/finesse.php>